

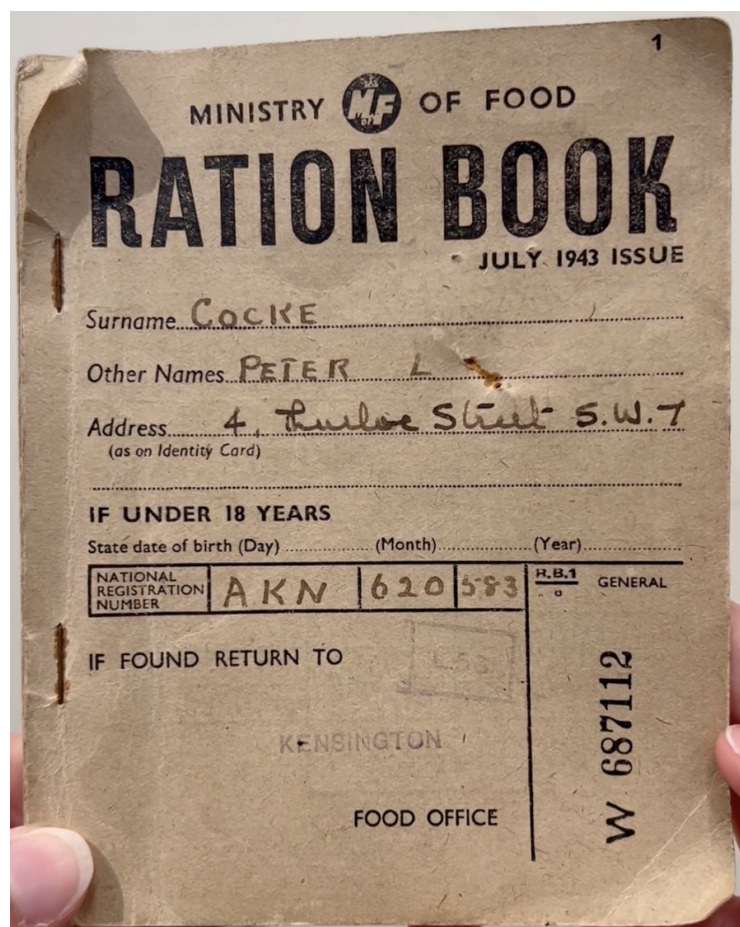
Object 1: Ration Book

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What is this object? Can you spot any key words to help you work out what it is?

- Ration book is written on the front cover
- Ask students if they know what a ration book was used for. If you haven't previously covered rationing in class, students may have prior knowledge from books and films.

Answer: This is a ration book. There were shortages of certain items during World War Two, so rationing was introduced to allocate these things fairly.



Question 2: Do you know what was rationed during World War Two? See if you can spot any clues in the video.

- Hopefully students will spot the 'meat' and 'tea' coupons. Many foods, including these, were rationed with food-specific coupons.
- Other rationed foods included **FILL IN HERE**
- Students might have come across the 'dig for victory' campaign before, where the public were encouraged to grow their own food to help reduce food shortages.
- There's a section at the back of the book (0:17-0:20 on the video) which has 'Points' rather than specific foods. Some foods fluctuated in demand and availability, and the number of points required for these was reduced or increased in response to this.
 - Foods rationed using points included biscuits, cereals and tinned goods.
- You could also see if students know of any foods which were not rationed. These include:
 - Potatoes, bread, fish, fruit, veg and coffee were not rationed

Answer: You might have spotted the 'meat' and 'tea' coupons in this ration book. Lots of other foods were also rationed, including butter, sugar and eggs.

Did you spot the 'Points' page at the end of the ration book? Points were used to ration foods such as biscuits, cereals and tinned goods. The number of points needed for each item depended on availability and demand.

Summary: So now we know that there were food shortages in Britain during World War Two. Let's look at the next object and see what else we can find out!

Object 2: Land Army Trousers

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What is this object? See if you can spot anything interesting about it.

Students might notice details such as:

- Button fastenings at the side, rather than a zip fly. Zips as we know them were invented in the early 20th Century, and were fairly common on clothing in Europe by World War Two. Buttons are easier and cheaper to mend.
- The legs are very short. They would be worn with long socks and boots, so the shorter leg was better for tucking in.
- Lace up cuffs - students will be encouraged to think about these more through the question.



Question 2: Look at the lace up cuffs. Why might somebody need the bottom of their trouser leg to be tight?

- Keeps dirt out - encourage students to think about the kinds of jobs where this would be useful.
- Keeps cold air out - good for working outside all year round
- Keeps the fabric out of the way - just like cycle clips are used to keep trouser legs out of the way of the wheels and chain, the cuffs kept the legs out of the way of tools and machinery.

Question 3: Does the material look delicate or durable? Why might someone need trousers made from this type of fabric?

- Durable, solid fabric - they're made of corduroy, which is hard-wearing
- Can withstand kneeling down, walking long distances, doesn't rip easily
- It's a good fabric for clothing for physical jobs
- It protects you from the cold, which is important if you're working outdoors

Answer: These trousers are made out of sturdy corduroy, which is long-lasting and warm. It was worn by farm workers throughout the 20th Century.

Object 3: Propaganda Poster

Give students a few seconds to look carefully at the image, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What can you see in this poster? Think about the words, colours, and images.

There are lots of elements to this image which students might comment on:

- Words: 'Join the Women's Land Army' 'For a healthy, happy job'. Encourage students to think about why these words have been chosen and what influence they might have.
- Land Girl: Students might recognise the trousers in the image as the previous object. The woman is wearing the standard Land Army uniform, and they can see how the trousers were worn tucked in to long socks to protect the legs. She is carrying her tool and jacket, looking content and relaxed.
- Background: Blue sky and fields. Prompt students to consider how this makes them feel (e.g. it may make them feel calm or relaxed).

Answer: When men joined the army, there was a shortage of farm workers. Britain's food supplies were already a concern (think back to the ration book we saw earlier), so women were encouraged to join the Women's Land Army. They prepared the land, grew and harvested crops and looked after animals, as well as lots of other jobs to keep the farms running.



Question 2: Think about all the different things you can see in the poster. Does joining the Women's Land Army look like a positive or negative experience?

- The poster paints a positive image of life in the WLA.
- When students answer this question, encourage them to use specific elements of the poster to back up their opinion.
- For example: It looks like you'll get to work outside in beautiful weather, just like the woman in the image. It's a 'healthy, happy job', and the woman is smiling. They might also notice that she is clean and her hair is very neat - it doesn't look like she's been doing lots of difficult manual labour.

Object 3: Propaganda Poster (cont.)

Question 3: Do you think that work in the Women's Land Army was as happy and peaceful as the poster makes it look?

- Encourage students to think about the work that members of the WLA were undertaking - preparing fields, planting and harvesting crops, and caring for farm animals.
- Think about the weather in the image, and encourage students to imagine what the work would have been like on a freezing cold, rainy winter morning.

Answer: Work in the Women's Land Army could be tough. It was hard, manual work, often in the cold and rain, and the hours were long.

Women in the land army worked 48 hours each week in the winter, and 50 each week in the summer.



Question 4: This poster was produced by the British Government during World War Two. Why do you think the government presented joining the Women's Land Army as a positive experience?

- If you've already covered the idea of propaganda in class, see if they can identify this poster as propaganda.
- Think about the government's intention behind creating the poster. What did they want to achieve?
 - They needed women to join the WLA. Bring back themes that the class discussed in the previous question - would people want to join the WLA if the poster showed a cold, dark, rainy morning with a woman looking exhausted?

Answer: Propaganda is created to make people think or behave in a particular way. This poster is an example of government propaganda in Britain during World War Two. This poster was created to influence and encourage women to join the Women's Land Army.

Summary: Aha! So the trousers were worn by women in the Land Army, when they were working to produce food. This is all starting to come together. Are you ready to look at our final objects?

Object 4: Green Armband



Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the investigation question.

Question 1: What is this object? Can you work out how it might have been used?

- Think about the letters - what do you think WLA stands for?
- Think about the shape and size of the object, and functional elements such as the buttons and buttonholes.
- Don't worry if students don't figure out that it's an armband

Answer: This is a Women's Land Army armband. Worn around the upper arm, these armbands are made of wool and identified people as members of the Women's Land Army.

Summary: Have a look at the next object. It's another armband, but it's a little bit different.

Object 5: Red Armband

Play the video, encouraging students to look carefully at the object, then reveal the first investigation question.

Question 1: What are the differences between the two armbands?

- Different colour - the first was dark green, this is bright red.
- More diamonds - the first had two, and this has four.



Question 2: Why do you think there are more diamonds on this one?

- This is a chance to see what students come up with - take some guesses or ask them to discuss in small groups, and then reveal the answer.

Answer: The diamonds show how long someone has been in the Land Army. A diamond was added for each year of service.

Question 3: Can you work out how long this person has spent in the land army?

- This person spent 4 years in the WLA - there are 4 diamonds.

Answer: After 4 years' service, members of the Women's Land Army were given a red armband to replace their dark green one, and after 6 years, a yellow armband was awarded.

Summary: Wow, we've found out so much information from these objects! Click on the button below to learn some more about the Women's Land Army.

Once you click the 'Learn More' button, students will be given more information about the Women's Land Army by Grace, the character that they met at the beginning of the session.

After that, use the activity prompt and get your students making their own Land Army recruitment posters. Use the links on the 'Teacher Guide' page of the website to view additional examples.

Check out the 'adaptations' section of the Teacher Guide page for ideas that could make this session more accessible to a range of students.